

Qixuan (Cherry) He

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Education

Boston University, College of Communication

Sept. 2025 - May 2027

M.A. in Emerging Media Studies; Dean's Scholarship

Thesis: AI Heuristics and Female Political Evaluation

Advisors: Dr. Joshua Baldwin and Dr. Chris Wells

Shanghai Jiao Tong University, School of Media and Communication

Sept. 2021 - Jul. 2025

B.A. in Cultural Industries Management; Outstanding Graduate

University of Amsterdam, School of Social and Behavioral Science

Apr. 2024 - Dec. 2024

Exchange Student

Research Interests

Topics: political communication; media psychology; social perception and stereotypes; emerging media contexts.

Methods: computational, experimental, and psychophysiological methods.

Publications

Peer-reviewed Journal Publications

- Huang, Y., He, Q., & Li, B. (2025). Cultural participation and psychological wellbeing: The mediating role of transcendence. *Humanities & Social Sciences Communications*, 12(1), 1-11. <https://doi.org/10.1057/s41599-025-05691-1>
- Zhou, D., Xu, Y., & He, Q. (2023). New media use and mental health of married women: Mediating effects of marital quality. *Healthcare*, 11(21), 2909. <https://doi.org/10.3390/healthcare11212909>

Manuscripts Under Review / In Preparation

- Huang, Y., He, Q., & Blake, H. (2026). Professional gaming experience and psychological well-being in elite esports players: A parallel mediation model. Manuscript under review at *Scientific Reports*.
- He, Q., & Zhou, D. (2026). From motherhood to capital: The resilient entrepreneurship of Chinese mom bloggers amid platform precarity. Manuscript under review at *Gender Issues*.
- Pu, X., He, Q., Li, M., & Jiang, X. (2026). Who Is Responsible for AI Misuse? Contextual-Moral Attribution in Twitter/X Discourse. Manuscript under review at *Human Communication Research*.
- He, Q., & Jiang, X. (in preparation). Platformed public opinion toward Chinese international students in the United States: A computational analysis of stereotype and threat discourse.
- He, Q., & Baldwin, J. (in preparation). Evaluating women in engineering: AI source cues, gender stereotypes, and person perception.

Conference Presentations

- Liu, C., & He, Q. (2026, August). *When art meets ecology: The moralization of the Himalaya firework display as an environmental spectacle on Chinese social media*. Poster presented at AEJMC, Communicating Science, Health, Environment, and Risk Division, New Orleans, USA.
- Chen, S., He, Q., & Hu, X. (2026, August). *Digital Infrastructure as the E in E-Governance: A Scoping Review*. Poster presented at AEJMC, Communication Technology Division, New Orleans, USA.
- He, Q. (2026, June). *"I want to balance care and clicks": Negotiated empowerment among grassroots mom influencers in China*. Paper presented at ICA, Feminism Scholarship Division, Cape Town, South Africa.
- Chen, J., & He, Q. (2026, March). *"He made a mistake that every man would make, but she is a sl*t": Gendered discourse in political sex scandals on Reddit*. Paper accepted by the AEJMC Midwinter Conference, Political Communication Division.

- Baldwin, J., Hahn, L., Novozhilova, E., Andreeva, I., Guvelioglu, L., Jia, D. Y., Taggart, M., Chen, Z., **He, Q.**, Kim, W., Liu, C., & Lyu, A. (2026, February). *A scoping review of affective disposition theory of drama*. Paper presented at the Moral Media Conference, Gainesville, FL, United States.
- **He, Q.**, & Huang, Y. (2025, April). *Inspired by civilizational connectedness: How extended reality enhances entertainment gratifications in heritage experiences*. Poster presented at the SJTU-IAMCR Emerging Media Forum, Shanghai, China.
- Zhou, D., **He, Q.**, & Luo, P. (2024, July). *Polarization and convergence: Exploring trends and causes of gender ideology changes among Chinese women in the digital age*. Paper presented at the Annual Conference of the Chinese Sociological Association, Gender Sociology Division, Harbin, China.

Membership

- Communication Research Center, Boston University, Boston
- Feminism Scholarship Division & Communication Science and Biology Interest Group, International Communication Association (ICA)
- Communication Technology Division & Communicating Science, Health, Environment, and Risk Division, The Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC)

Research Experience

Computational Research on Societal Issues (CRSI) Lab

Oct. 2025 - Present

Research Assistant & Lab Member | Boston University | Guided by Dr. Xiaoya Jiang

- Conduct human coding of social media discourse on immigration and other contentious societal issues.
- Use topic modeling, sentiment analysis, and time series analysis to examine public opinion toward minority groups.
- Identify public frames related to prejudice, stereotypes, and group identity in online discussions.
- Contribute to data interpretation, and manuscript development on digital discourse and intergroup perception.

Story Technology and Audience Response (STAR) Lab

Sept. 2025 – May 2026

Lab Member | Boston University | Guided by Dr. Joshua Baldwin

- Assist with scoping review coding and scale development on narrative engagement, media enjoyment and appreciation.
- Design experimental materials for media psychology research, including videos, audios, chatbots, and social media pages.
- Develop and conduct lab experiments to measure implicit attitudes, explicit attitudes, and psychophysiological responses by using tools such as PsychoPy, iMotion, and Shimmer GSR+.

Women Empowerment through Short-Video Platforms

Jun. 2023 - Jul. 2024

Researcher | Shanghai Jiao Tong University | Guided by Dr. Dong Zhou

- Supported to access and clean Chinese national datasets (CGSS and CFPS) for specific research topics, such as “Chinese women’s social media use and mental health”.
- Interviewed 25+ female practitioners in the short-video-related industry, including mom influencers, female PRs, etc.
- Contributed to literature review and manuscript preparation on gendered consequences of media participation.

Participatory Public Cultural Experiences and Social Well-Being

May 2022 - Jun. 2023

Researcher | Shanghai Jiao Tong University | Guided by Dr. Yitong Huang

- Designed and implemented online surveys and recruited more than 1,600 participants.
- Applied structural equation modeling to examine how media affordances shape psychological responses and wellbeing.
- Contributed to research on extended reality, cultural participation, self-transcendence, and entertainment gratifications.

Awards and Honors

- COM Graduate Prize for Academic Achievement (\$1,000), Boston University (2026)
- Feminist Scholarship Division Travel Grant (\$300), International Communication Association (2026)
- COM Graduate Dean’s Scholarship (\$30,000), Boston University (2025-2026)
- Outstanding Graduate, Shanghai Jiao Tong University (2025)
- Excellent Volunteer, Gansu UNESCO Association (2024)
- Undergraduate Excellence Scholarship (\$500), Shanghai Jiao Tong University (2021-2024)
- Merit Student, Shanghai Jiao Tong University (2023)
- Undergraduate Chinese National Innovation Grant (\$1000), Shanghai Jiao Tong University (2023)
- Xiaomi Scholarship (\$700), Shanghai Jiao Tong University (2022)

Professional Experience

CM180 | Teaching Assistant Sept. 2026 - Present

- Facilitated in-class activities and discussions for the 200+ student course, providing real-time instructional support.
- Mentored 20+ student project groups, offering feedback on theory application, critical analysis, and video planning.
- Graded assignments and projects, tracked attendance, and managed grades.

Insightworks | Quantitative Research Intern Apr. 2025 - May 2025

- Conducted quantitative analysis of consumer research data for skincare products, using t-tests to identify differences in user evaluations.
- Integrated Likert-scale ratings with video-based qualitative responses to generate mixed-format consumer insights.
- Synthesized statistical findings into research reports for product evaluation and market positioning.

ICCI-SJTU | Healthcare Branding Intern Apr. 2024 - Dec. 2024

- Designed a mixed-methods study with 300+ surveys and 50+ structured interviews with doctors, nurses, and patients.
- Prepared reports summarizing service strengths, communication problems, and strategic recommendations for hospital branding.

Leadership and Service

Chinese Family Panel Studies, Peking University | Research Interviewer Jun. 2024 – Jul. 2024

- Conducted structured interviews and collected demographic and survey data with high accuracy.
- Maintained detailed records and ensured compliance with data privacy requirements.

SMC Youth Volunteers Association, Shanghai Jiao Tong University | President Apr. 2022 - Apr. 2023

- Organized 10+ volunteer events, supporting international marathons, conferences, and rural volunteer teaching programs.
- Coordinated volunteer teams, partner communication, participation records, and on-site event logistics.

History Museum of Shanghai Jiao Tong University | Head of Student Publicity Department Oct. 2022 - Sept. 2023

- Edited 30+ news articles and event announcements to support museum communication and public engagement.
- Coordinated cultural events and multimedia content, including immersive museum games and visitor-facing materials.

Skills

Data Analysis: SPSS, R, Python, Amos, NVivo.

Experimental Tools: PsychoPy, iMotion, Qualtrics, Pavlovia, Shimmer GSR+.

Digital and Media Tools: Phoenix (html), WordPress, Canva, Photoshop, Adobe Creative Suite.

Language Proficiency

Chinese: Native

English: Advanced academic proficiency